



SanDisk Cruiser Orbit

SanDisk launched its Cruiser Orbit USB flash drive which has a 360° swivel design, and is available in capacities upto 32GB. <http://dgit.in/sancruorb>

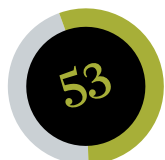
Toshiba's new ultrabook

Toshiba announced its 13-inch KIRAbok with an impressive 2560x1440 (221 ppi) panel making it the first non-Apple laptop to offer such high resolution. <http://dgit.in/10fSYuq>

Bazaar

Circle Attitude 2.1

Not enough attitude



Features	65
Performance.....	45
Build Quality	65
Value for money	35

Specifications

2.1 Channel speakers;
Wireless control pod;
detailed specifications: NA

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When it comes to Circle products, one thing that almost always stands out is the aesthetically pleasing design, coupled with just about average quality. The Attitude 2.1 speaker set that we got for review are no different in this regard. The speakers do look elegant and seem to have large drivers which promise a higher quality of sound than the average speaker. You also get a handy Bluetooth remote that is functional enough for us to wish that almost all PC speakers come with something like that. They do serve to alleviate the cable hassles that most PC users are plagued with.

The real meat of any set of speakers is in their aural prowess and unfortunately, this is where



these speakers fall flat, literally. The satellites by themselves are decent, and in fact, slightly better than our reference F&D F680s.

However, the woofer is just plain bad. It can't handle bass heavy tracks such as Massive Attack's *Angel* and even our "Heavy Drum" test track brought about the deficiencies in the woofer design. The only way to extract even a modicum of listening pleasure is if you turn the volume below 30 per cent. Are these speakers worth

the asking price, or even the market price?

No, unless you have some tone-deaf artist buddies that you would like to entertain on a budget. A better woofer would have gone a long way in making this a decent and possibly recommended speaker set. For now, the F680 will suffice.

Anirudh Regidi

Olympus STYLUS XZ-2

Wonderful successor to the XZ-1

The XZ-2 is the flagship point and shoot camera from Olympus's new STYLUS series and an upgrade to the impressive XZ-1. The XZ-2 has a metallic build, detachable rubber grip on the front and the thumb-rest on the rear side which give it a solid feel and it fits well in your hand. The camera is on a comparatively bulkier side thanks to the presence of a tilting LCD screen. The ring around the lens found on the XZ-1 is also present on the XZ-2 and has a decent click-stop mechanism which becomes a smooth zoom ring, when the Fn2 button in the front is pressed.

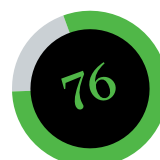
One of the strong points about Olympus high end cameras is the AF speed. Locking the focus in under a second in most daylight situations and not hunting for focus under low light is

the USP of the XZ-2. One thing we did not like about the XZ-2 is that the 35-point focus area arranged in the 7x5 grid is centre-heavy. In our studio tests, we noticed that the XZ-2 performed flawlessly between ISO 100 and ISO 800. Image quality starts deteriorating from ISO 3200 onwards. The STYLUS XZ-2 is blessed with a fast lens going from f/1.8 at the widest to f/2.5 at the telephoto end. These numbers ensured that we got impressive photographs even under low light conditions without having to ramp

up the ISO settings.

The biggest threat to the Olympus XZ-2 is the Sony RX100 whose larger sensor size puts it at an immediate advantage. So would we recommend the Olympus STYLUS XZ-2? Absolutely. A sub-30k pricing will be ideal.

Nimish Sawant



Features	80
Performance.....	75
Build Quality	80
Value for money	70

Specifications

Sensor: 12.1MP BSI CMOS;
Image Processor: TruePic VI; Optical zoom: 4x; Focal length: 28-112mm (35mm equivalent); Screen: 3-inch 920k-dot LCD; ISO range: 100-12800

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